DISPLAY NAME SPOOFING

TRAINING EXAMPLE ONLY · FICTIONAL COLLEGE · FICTIONAL PEOPLE

FROM (DISPLAY NAME)	Principal's Office
SENDER ADDRESS	**principal.office@greenfield-mail.invalid**
TO	Staff Member
SUBJECT	**Urgent: Staff Payment Approval**

Good morning,

I need you to purchase five gift cards immediately for an important staff appreciation event.

Please purchase them and send the redemption codes to me before 11:00 AM. I am currently in a confidential meeting and cannot take calls.

Kindly treat this as urgent.

Regards,
The Principal

RED-FLAG CALLOUTS

01 · DISPLAY NAME
The display name claims to be the Principal's Office. Display names are easy to copy; inspect the full sender address.

02 · SENDER DOMAIN
The address ends in **greenfield-mail.invalid**, not the college's verified domain.

03 · UNUSUAL PAYMENT
Gift cards and redemption codes are an unusual way to pay for an institutional event.

04 · URGENCY + SECRECY
The 11:00 AM deadline and claim that the sender cannot take calls discourage verification.

05 · REQUESTED ACTION
The sender wants staff to buy cards and send codes. Treat this as a high-risk payment request.

WHAT TO DO Do not buy cards or send codes. Verify through a known, independently obtained phone number or approved internal channel.

All names, addresses, institutions, amounts and links in this sample are fictional. The .invalid domain is reserved for invalid examples. No real person or organisation was contacted or targeted. Do not click or visit the example links.